



Curriculum and the Teacher

1. The Purpose of Education and the Curriculum
2. Accountability + the Regulatory Frameworks
3. The Role of Knowledge



- **A school's curriculum** enables it to **set out its vision for the knowledge, skills and values** that its pupils will **learn**, encompassing the national curriculum **within** a coherent **wider vision** for successful learning. (ITTECF3.1)
- Ensuring pupils **master foundational concepts and knowledge before moving on** is likely to build pupils' **confidence** and help them **succeed**. (ITTECF3.3)
- In order for pupils **to think critically**, they must have a **secure understanding of knowledge** within the **subject** area they are being asked to **think critically** about. (ITTECF3.6)
- **Every teacher** can **improve pupils' literacy**, including by **explicitly teaching reading, writing and oral language skills** specific to **individual disciplines**. (ITTECF3.10)

(1) The Purpose of Education and Curriculum

What do we mean by curriculum?

*'All the **learning experiences** planned and directed by the school to attain its educational goals' (Tyler 1957)*

'Planned experiences offered to the learner under guidance of the school' (Wheeler 1967)

‘Unplanned – Hidden Curriculum’ - *pupils learn more than is directly taught about the world through *how we teach and *what we say (Biesta, 2020)*

The school curriculum can be seen as the total learning experience help students to make meaning through a variety of lenses on the world (Ashby 2021)

Curriculum as **a plan = Implementation - Impact** on pupil learning

ITTECF defines the function of a school's curriculum as being to
set out its vision of for the knowledge skills and values that its pupils will learn encompassing the national curriculum within a coherent wider vision for successful learning

What is the Curriculum?

National Curriculum 1989 → 2010 → 2014 → ???

= specialised and individualised in local schools → yet **Global similarities** but no global assumption

- **Acquire knowledge** – beyond everyday knowledge – clear boundaries
- **Purpose of school curriculum** – give **access** to '**Powerful Knowledge**' – a resource to think deeply

Distinguishing **curriculum** from

- *teaching activities and
- *assessment

Curriculum:
WHAT is taught

Teaching activities:
HOW curriculum
content is taught

Assessment
Desired high level outcomes
and measures of those
outcomes

(Fearn 2018)

What is meant by 'Curriculum'?

'Every subject is on its own quest for truth' (Christine Counsell)

'What story do you want your curriculum to tell?' (Mark Esner)

What is the purpose of your subject?

Planned curriculum

Received curriculum

Informal curriculum

Hidden curriculum

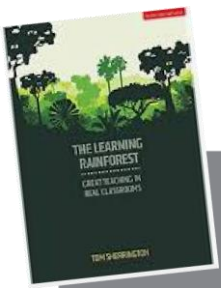
Tim Oates has suggested that 'curriculum' has multiple meanings⁴⁷:

Intended curriculum: the required knowledge, skills and understanding that might be written down in the specification for a unit of study.

Enacted curriculum: the curriculum that students actually experience as delivered by their teachers, each teacher applying their own filter, adding or subtracting content, deploying a unique combination of learning tasks and resources.

Assessed curriculum: the knowledge, skills and understanding that students encounter in their assessments – normally a subset of a much wider curriculum.

Learned curriculum: the knowledge, skills and understanding that students are left with at a later time. (As referenced earlier, Nuthall's work suggests that this will be unique to each student in any class.)



THE CURRICULUM DEBATE

CHAPTER 3

“

WE WANT OUR CHILDREN TO HAVE IT ALL: KNOWLEDGE AND UNDERSTANDING ACROSS MULTIPLE DOMAINS; A RANGE OF PRACTICAL AND INTELLECTUAL SKILLS AND A RANGE OF CHARACTER TRAITS - RENAISSANCE PEOPLE.

(Sherrington 2017)



“

WHAT WE TEACH AND HOW WE TEACH ARE INTERLINKED IN THE ENACTED CURRICULUM.

“

CURRICULUM IS SPECIFIED IN DIFFERENT WAYS BUT THERE IS ALWAYS SOME ROOM FOR TEACHER INPUT - OFTEN A LOT OF FREEDOM TO CHOOSE THE BOOKS AND HISTORICAL PERIODS THAT STUDENTS STUDY.

“

THE CORE KNOWLEDGE DEBATE IS VITAL - WHAT KNOWLEDGE SHOULD ALL STUDENTS HAVE? ANY SELECTION HAS CULTURAL BIAS - SO WHAT DO WE INCLUDE AND EXCLUDE?

“

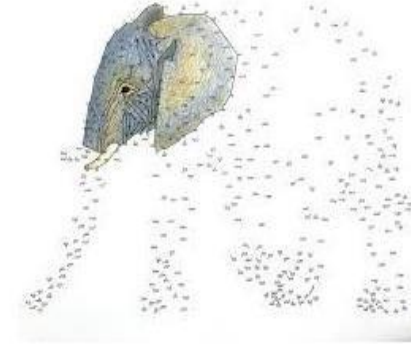
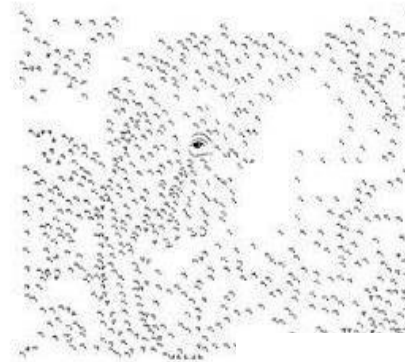
CULTURAL CAPITAL NEEDS TO BE TAUGHT DELIBERATELY - AND SHOULD INCLUDE EXPERIENCES LIKE CONCERTS, PLAYS, WALKING IN MOUNTAINS, VISITING MUSEUMS AND ENGAGING IN CURRENT AFFAIRS.

“

BEYOND TEACHING 'THE BEST THAT'S BEEN THOUGHT AND SAID' WE'RE TRYING TO GIVE STUDENTS THE KNOWLEDGE TO ENGAGE IN 'THE CONVERSATION OF MANKIND'.

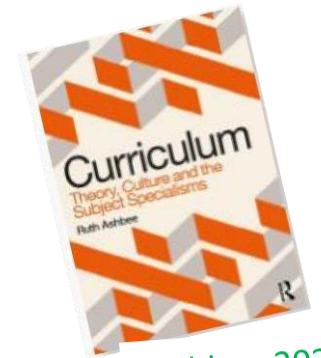
Novice

Expert



Dr A Carroll

Consider the elephants (in the room)



(Ashbee 2021)

- Curriculum, or the substance of what is taught, is the **core business** of schools, - provides a common framework and practical strategies for the successful implementation of **powerful knowledge-based curriculum for all**.
- insights across the subject divides**, key elements of curriculum design including progression, sequencing, substantive and disciplinary knowledge, and the relationships of subjects
- Advice for the **codification** of curriculum also outlined.



REAL CLASSROOMS, REAL STUDENTS REAL TEACHERS

INTRODUCTION

“

THE LEARNING RAINFOREST METAPHOR IS AN ATTEMPT TO CAPTURE MY UNDERSTANDING AND EXPERIENCE OF TEACHING. INDIVIDUAL SPECIMENS IN THEIR DIVERSE GLORY CREATE BEAUTY AND INSPIRE AWE; COMPLEXITY, DIVERSITY AND UNPREDICTABILITY ARE UNDERPINNED BY SCIENCE.

“

THE ELEMENTS OF EACH TREE IN THE RAINFOREST REPRESENT A DIFFERENT ASPECT OF THE LEARNING PROCESS:

- THE ROOTS: ESTABLISHING THE CONDITIONS FOR GREAT LEARNING;
- THE TRUNK AND BRANCHES: BUILDING THE KNOWLEDGE STRUCTURE;
- THE CANOPY: EXPLORING THE POSSIBILITIES.

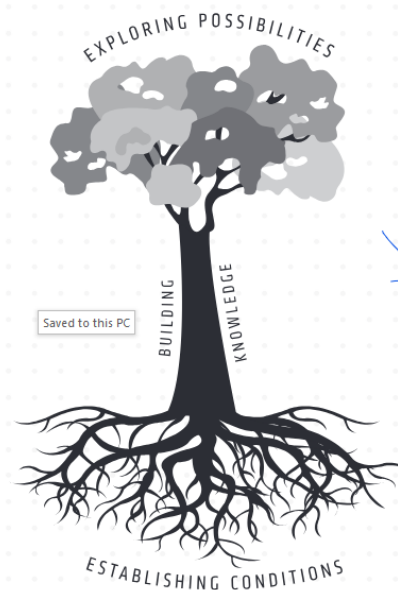
EACH ONE SUPPORTS THE OTHERS; NONE EXISTS WITHOUT THE OTHERS.

“

PART 2 HAS THREE CHAPTERS WITH 20 SUB-SECTIONS; STRATEGIES AND IDEAS THAT SUPPORT THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE THREE PARTS OF THE TREE MODEL. YOU CAN DIP INTO EACH SECTION SEPARATELY OR READ THE BOOK FROM START TO FINISH.

“

PART 1 OF THE BOOK EXPLORES THE KEY DEBATES AND INFLUENCES THAT SUPPORT THE MODEL: TRADITIONAL vs PROGRESSIVE PHILOSOPHIES; THE CURRICULUM DEBATE AND THE LEARNING FROM EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH.



- ❑ Short-term = Teacher
- ❑ Medium term plan = School + Teacher
- ❑ Longer-term = National exams

WEAVING TECHNIQUES

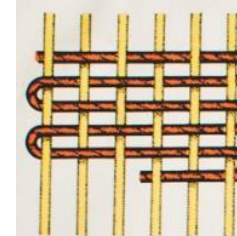


Fig. A Tabby Weaving

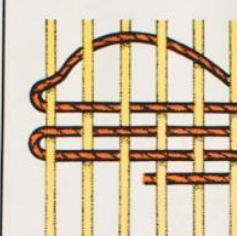


Fig. B Bubbling

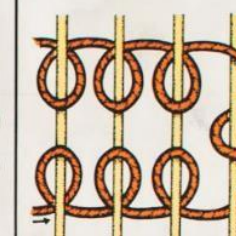


Fig. C Egyptian Knot

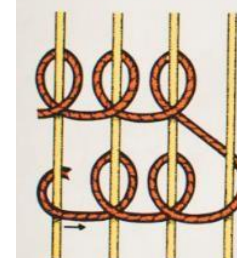


Fig. D Soumak

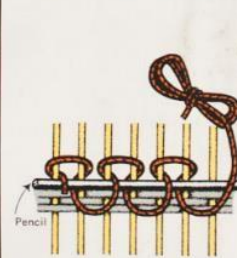


Fig. E Rya on a Pencil

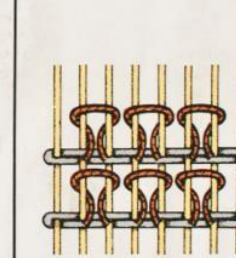


Fig. F Rya (Shag)

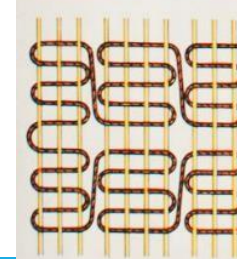


Fig. G Spanish Lace

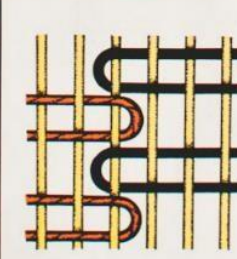
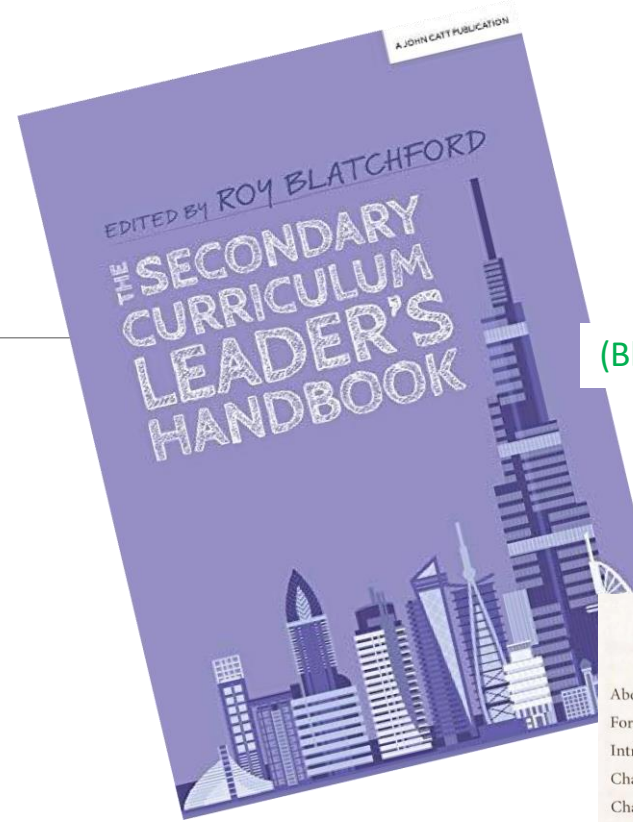
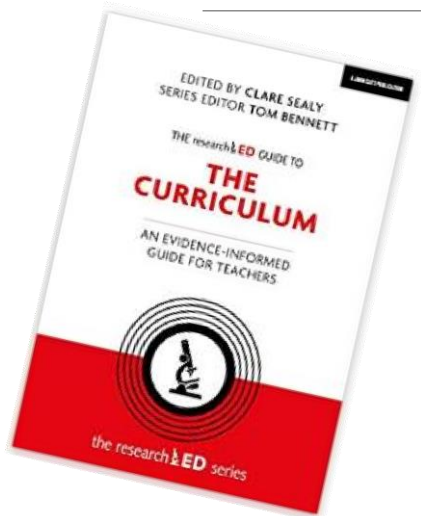


Fig. H Interlocking

Taking the curriculum seriously



(Blatchford 2019)

Backwards planning (ch 13)

- Practical guidance via case-studies
- Explore questions of whose knowledge
- Understand the theory behind the curriculum

- ❑ What knowledge? – choice = *ethical responsibility*..
- ❑ 'the best of what has been thought and said' – whose knowledge/ who decides.. power.
- ❑ Knowledge *changes us* by inducing our curiosity + capacity for new knowledge... and making subsequent learning possible .. Need to recognise this important role.. (Council 2018)

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The importance of your Curriculum Thinking?

The school's curriculum **creates a shared understanding** about knowledge, skills, and values to be taught to the learner and why - as Mary Myatt said
= **like a good road map** - it shows **the final destination** and (hopefully) the **best way** to get there
(Judd, 2018)

A high quality and well thought out curriculum (Coe et al) 2020 emphasise is an integral part of maintaining a quality teaching and the quality of teaching is hugely important factor in **securing positive outcomes** for children and young people

(2) The Regulatory Framework

1) Organisations:

- **The Department for Education** (DfE): is **responsible** for **children's services and education** including early years schools higher and further education policy apprenticeships and wider skills in England
- **OFSTED**: is the **office for standards in education children's services and skills**. They **inspect** services providing education and skills for learners of all ages. They also inspect and **regulate services that care** for children and young people.

2) Standards:

- **National Curriculum DfE 2014**

This is a **set of subjects** and standards used by primary and secondary schools so children learn the same things – it represents the minimum entitlement for state funded schools

3) Teachers' Standards (DfE 2021)

Define the **minimum level of practise expected of trainees and teachers** from the point of being awarded Qualified Teacher Status - are **used to assess all trainees working towards QTS** and all those completing their statutory induction. The standards emphasised the importance of curriculum by supporting teachers to

- promote good progress and outcomes
- demonstrate good subject and curriculum knowledge
- plan and teach well-structured lessons.

Head Teachers Standards (DfE, 2020) for *curriculum and *assessment – a school must;

- Ensure a broad **structured and coherent curriculum** entitlement sets out the skills, knowledge and values that will be taught
- Establish **effective curricular leadership** – develop subject leaders with high levels of expertise.
- Ensure **valid, reliable** and proportionate approaches for **assessing pupils' knowledge** and understanding of the curriculum.

Frameworks

1) Initial Teacher training and Early Careers Framework (ITTECF) (DfE 2024)

formerly the Core Content Framework + Early career frameworks

Designed to support trainee development in **five core areas** = Behaviour management, Pedagogy, Curriculum, Assessment, Professional Behaviours = two types of content within each area key evidence statements

***learn that** and practise statements

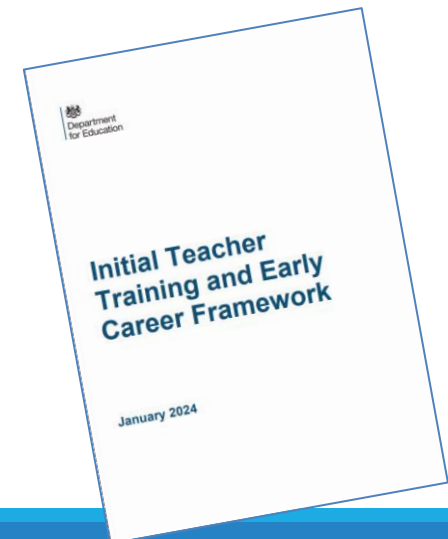
***learn how** have been informed by their high-quality evidence and expertise.

2) National Professional Qualifications Frameworks (DfE 2022)

NPQ's are designed to support the professional development of **teachers and leaders**, NPQ's are designed to provide training and support **for teachers at all levels** NPQ's mirror the ITTECF –

☐ key *evidence statements* **learned that** and

☐ *practise statements* **learn how** to in relation to the curriculum and assessment.



OFSTED INSPECTION FRAMEWORK (2019)

Regulating body and inspection of schools - quality of education, behaviour and attitudes, leadership, management, personal development

Quality of education judgement

- **Curriculum intent**
- **Curriculum implementation**
- **Curriculum impact**



Guidance

Education inspection framework: for use from November 2025

Updated 9 September 2025

Applies to England

- Contents
- [Introduction](#)
- [Principles of inspection](#)
- [Provision inspected under the education inspection framework](#)
- [The evaluation scale used for inspection](#)
- [The evaluation areas graded on inspection](#)
- [Arrangements for different](#)
- See: 13.15

! For use on inspections from 10 November 2025.

Introduction

The education inspection framework ('the framework') sets out how Ofsted inspects registered early years settings, maintained schools, academies, non-association independent schools and further education and skills provision in England (for a full list,



Guidance

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Consultation outcome

Improving the way Ofsted inspects education: consultation document

Updated 9 September 2025

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Foreword: what we want to achieve

Ofsted works in the interests of children, learners, parents and carers. Our aim is to help raise standards in education, skills and children's social care and therefore improve the lives of children and learners – particularly the most disadvantaged.



Curriculum

Causing concern	Attention needed	Secure	Strong	Exemplary
The curriculum is likely to be 'causing concern' if one or more of the following applies: The curriculum lacks ambition, structure or coherence. Leaders have not considered its content and sequencing sufficiently. The narrow range of subjects does not prepare pupils for the opportunities, responsibilities and experiences of life in Britain. The curriculum lacks ambition for disadvantaged pupils and/or pupils with SEND.	Leadership of the curriculum			Where a school is secure in all evaluation areas, and strong across all the themes in curriculum, inspectors may consider a feature of leaders' work to be exemplary. All considerations of exemplary practice will be moderated and confirmed by the national quality and consistency panel. This will include whether the practice is: ▪ embedded and sustained over time ▪ making a tangible difference to pupils' learning, development and well-being ▪ being used and/or adapted internally to support and improve other areas of the school's work ▪ being (or will be) shared externally to
	The curriculum is limited in breadth, depth or ambition in some subjects and/or for some groups of pupils. Some subject/phase leaders do not have the expertise, support or time they need to design, adapt or adopt an appropriate curriculum. The curriculum in some subjects/areas is not designed effectively to build pupils' knowledge and skills sequentially and cumulatively. Teaching, revisiting or practising knowledge and skills are not given enough time.	Leaders make sure that the curriculum is at least as ambitious in breadth and depth as the national curriculum, for all pupils. Subject/area curriculums are well designed to build pupils' knowledge and skills sequentially and cumulatively. Subject/phase leaders have the expertise and/or support they need to ensure that the curriculum achieves its aims. Leaders make sure that the curriculum allows enough time for teaching, practising and revisiting content, and for addressing any gaps in pupils' knowledge as quickly as possible.	The curriculum is expertly designed at each stage to enable pupils to develop secure, deep and fluent knowledge. This paves the way for future learning. The curriculum, whether designed, adapted or adopted, has been expertly developed over time to ensure its continued quality, effectiveness and, where relevant, subject-specific rigour.	
	Communication and language, reading, writing and mathematics			
	The curriculum provides limited opportunity for pupils to develop their reading, language and vocabulary, both in spoken and/or written form, across a range of subjects.	The curriculum extends pupils' language and vocabulary, both in spoken and written form, and increases their reading competency across all subjects. For primary-age pupils and for older pupils where necessary, the curriculum prioritises accurate	The school has an expertly designed curriculum, which develops pupils' reading and writing through high-quality texts and increasingly broad vocabulary across all subjects.	



	For primary-age pupils and for older pupils where necessary , the curriculum does not place a strong enough emphasis on accurate and fluent word reading, handwriting, spelling and mathematics.	and fluent word reading, spelling, handwriting and mathematics.		support system improvement. Once the provisional grades are confirmed and the school's report card is published, inspectors will invite leaders to submit a short case study of their work to the Ofsted Academy. We will use a panel of experts to review these case studies nationally.
	Inclusive curriculum culture and practices			
	Weaknesses in design and/or poorly considered adaptations limit some pupils' access to a broad and ambitious curriculum.	The curriculum is an entitlement for every pupil. Any adaptations are made carefully to avoid limiting expectations for disadvantaged pupils or pupils with SEND. Leaders take all reasonable steps to make sure that all pupils, including those attending alternative provision and those with SEND, can study an equally ambitious curriculum.	Leaders make sure that all pupils gain the knowledge and skills to prepare them well to access the full curriculum and the next stage of learning.	Successful submissions will be published as part of a series of best practice reporting.

ACCOUNTABILITY AND THE CURRICULUM

Concern about:

- **teaching to the test** or **gaming which qualifications** they put some pupils through leading to
- a **narrowing of pupils curriculum experience** - need reforms to ensure a **more ambitious curriculum** but still
- need impact on pupils to **do well in exams** school results are
- published in **league tables** and an **Ofsted grade** can make a **big difference** to how a **school**
 - attracts pupils and
 - teachers a schools curriculum takes on
- different roles meet the needs of learners fulfil national accountability measures enacted by teachers

3) The Role of Knowledge

A **fundamental goal** of education is to **improve children's lives and life chances** (Coe et al 2020)

Raising the quality of teaching is probably the **single most effective thing we can do** to **promote** both overall **attainment** and **equity** (William 2018)

A **good curriculum** is one of the **most important resource** is that contributes to high quality teaching

The **curriculum has to be taught** – your **understanding and knowledge** of the **content and how it is learned** is **crucial**

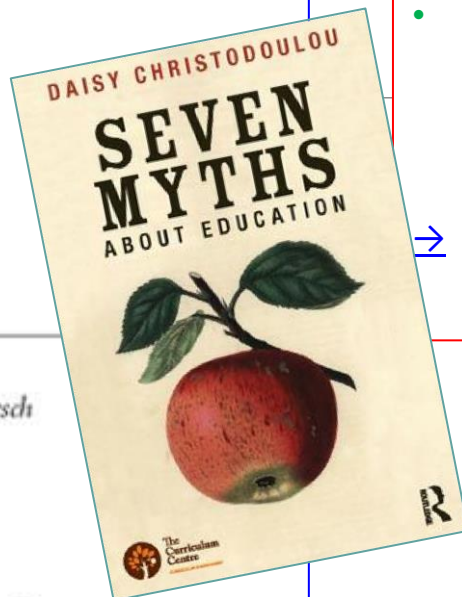
Question – **what knowledge?** Is set out in the curriculum?

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Foreword by Professor E.D. Hirsch
Foreword by Dylan Wiliam
Acknowledgements

Introduction

- 1 Myth 1: facts prevent understanding
- 2 Myth 2: teacher-led instruction is passive
- 3 Myth 3: the twenty-first century fundamentally changes everything
- 4 Myth 4: you can always just look it up
- 5 Myth 5: we should teach transferable skills
- 6 Myth 6: projects and activities are the best way to learn
- 7 Myth 7: teaching knowledge is indoctrination



The importance of knowledge is clear;

- a strong theoretical model that explains why knowledge is at the heart of cognition.
- strong empirical evidence about
 - the success of curricula that teach knowledge.
 - success of pedagogy that promotes the effective transmission of knowledge.

⇒ If we fail to teach knowledge, pupils fail to learn.

Knowledge matters!

The attainment gap for disadvantaged pupils is essentially a vocabulary and knowledge gap → explained by the 'Matthew effect' – of cumulative advantage – knowledge begets knowledge – so grows as children get older... (Hirsh 2000)

Gift of Education =

→ 'opportunity to pass on to the next generation our knowledge about the world
- an ethical responsibility ...'

'It is our children's inheritance...' (Enser 2019)

- ☐ worthwhile – society – verified by learned communities ...
- ☐ cognitively superior?
- ☐ support useful citizens capable of interpreting out world
- ☐ Sustainable – just democracy – face to give access – respect for authority??

Big Question:

Specialist knowledge vs Skills development
(England) (Europe, OEDC, Wales..)

Disciplinary knowledge → boundaries and communities of practice
specialist knowledge developed by academics – beyond the everyday experience
entitlement to access it through the curriculum..
represents a progressive agenda for social justice... ongoing quest for truth..

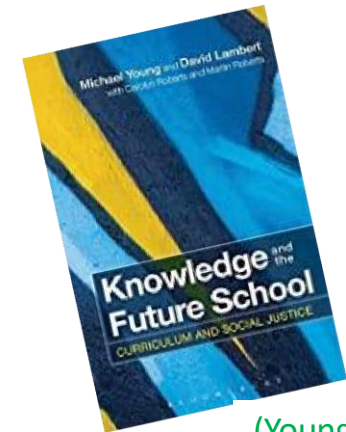
21st Century skills → generic work-employment skills

Further debates centre around;

- Traditional vs Progressive
- Subject vs interdisciplinary
- Teacher as sage on the stage vs guide on the side



St Mary's
University
Twickenham
London
School of
Education



(Young et al 2014)

(Priestly 2019)

What are Schools for?

Historical perspective:

- ❑ schooling = restricted to a tiny elite until mid 19th century
- ❑ 1870 – compulsory (for all children in almost all countries)
- ❑ School leaving age – continued to rise from 11 yrs – 18 yrs
- ❑ Higher Ed = growing proportion – Nordic countries 80%,
England 50% (from 3% in 1950s)
5/100 70s - now 4/10!
- ❑ Brazil – parents were paid to keep children at school!
- ❑ Universality of education is an accepted characteristic of modern society – OECD →
still an aspiration for 1 in 5 school aged children across the world!

What can schools do?

- Prepare students for life – changing world
- ability to ask questions
- socialisation?
- Knowledge of what? new and different ideas?

QUESTION? What can schools NOT do?

▲ too exam led → curriculum led schooling... current Education Inspection Framework

Concerns = economic – welfare → society increasingly complex .. linked to its global context =
... further complicated by the pandemic!



What should schools Teach?

Talk about a knowledge turn... which led to increase in importance of the curriculum

WHAT IS A KNOWLEDGE-RICH CURRICULUM?

- emphasises the importance of knowledge but also
- organise learning coherently to ensure that students form foundations that are built upon each year – horizontally + vertically to develop schema – to move from the novice to expert – addressing known misconceptions to establish a secure knowledge platform to reach the next level.
- This should included – experiences and values about what matters.

Main aspects:

- 1) Knowledge provides an underpinning philosophy – belief that people are empowered by this.
- 2) The content is specified in detail
- 3) Knowledge is taught to be remembered, not encountered for a long time after it was learnt – cognitive science, forgetting, retrieval, spaced practice, low status testing, atomicity, fluency....
- 4) It is sequenced + mapped deliberately – ensures students can make connections between topics rather than jumping from one topic to the next.

4) The Ambitious Curriculum and 'Powerful Knowledge'

Policy makers tend to **emphasise qualification** as the education system's main role

Ofsted emphasise the need to focus on the **knowledge aspect** of qualification - this leads to the importance of **pupils knowing more** and **remembering more** (Ofsted 2018)

Michael Young argues that curriculum should pass on **Powerful knowledge** (**Young 2014**) defines Powerful Knowledge - derived from academic disciplines which pupils could not encounter in their everyday life

This draws on the view that **knowledge is powerful** because it has been **developed tested** and improved by process of academics working in the subject disciplines which are **under continuous development** as a body of knowledge and a **unique lens on the world** - each discipline has its **own way of thinking** which is not the same..

This emphasises the **power of disciplinary knowledge** in **helping pupils become useful and informed citizens** capable of interpreting the world knowledge and **sustaining and supporting just democracy** whilst instilling respect for **authority** and the ability for **societal debate**

What should Schools Teach?

Even if children do go to school necessarily receiving a good education??

What → highly contested: what focus → which content selected...

Complex!! – rich curriculum is far more than a list of content!

Essential knowledge.. Education used as a cure for society's problems.. To help world become a better place – workforce drones.. If too instrumentalism– agendas for improving society – social mobility.. social justice etc.. eg) Parents + Teachers for Excellence (2019) made 114 proposals to include in school lessons – fake news...knife crime....drugs... Pupil strikes surrounding the climate emergency... All worthy aims.. BUT!

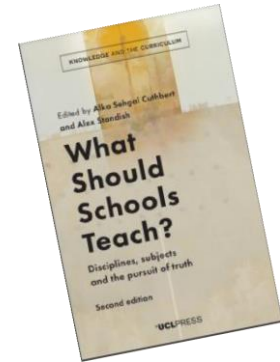
(Robinson 2018)

Knowledge selection – necessitates choice - values + power...
knowledge changes and is not equal..

Debate: Skills vs Knowledge: A Curriculum debate that matters and we need to reject! (Oats 2010)

- ❑ Wider participation vs Rigour and the importance of standards?
- ❑ What knowledge? = political agenda... who decides?

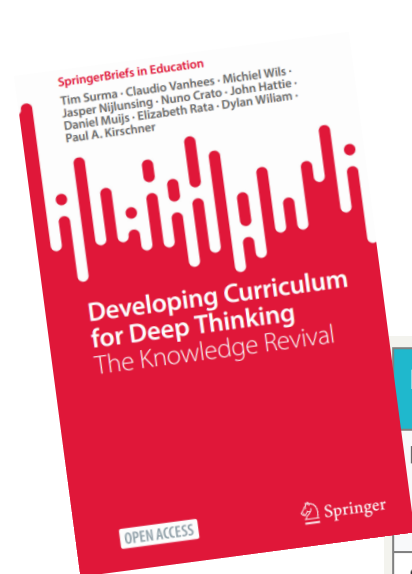
Curriculum based on concepts not contexts (changes) – fundamental concepts remain unchanged..



(Cuthbert and Standish 2021)

Why and how knowledge matters

Perspective/Area	Main Points	Supporting Evidence/Authors
Learning Perspective	Knowledge must be explicitly taught; builds memory and complex skills (critical thinking, problem solving, reading comprehension); domain-specific knowledge is vital.	Geary & Berch 2016; Baddeley & Hitch 1974; Ausubel 1968; Hattie 2023; Willingham 2019, 2021; Wiliam 2018
Sociological Perspective	Emphasises equal access to rich, powerful knowledge. Disciplinary knowledge combats social disparity. Teachers mediate complex academic content.	Barrett 2024; Rata 2024a; Muller 2000; Young 2007, 2009, 2013; Wheelahan 2007
Democratic Perspective	Shared, explicit knowledge underpins cultural literacy, equity, and citizenship. Prepares for societal participation.	Wiliam 2013; Hirsch 1988, 2009, 2016; Young 2007; Wheelahan 2010
Curriculum Concepts	Curriculum as a planned learning sequence; operates at many levels; influenced by societal and value-based decisions.	Taba 1962; Thijs & van den Akker 2009; Priestley et al. 2021; Kelly 2009
Curriculum Trends	Historical pendulum between content- and outcome-based models. Social realists propose a balanced, knowledge-rich approach (Future 3).	Young & Muller 2010
Knowledge-Rich Curriculum	Best is concept-led, content-rich, systematic (content richness, coherence, clarity); builds vocabulary and world knowledge, aligns with cognitive science and equity aims.	Oates 2011; Rata 2021; Hirsch 2016; Young & Lambert 2014
Impact & Evidence	Sustained, knowledge-rich curriculum can close achievement gaps and raise standards (longitudinal evidence).	Kim et al. 2021, 2023; Grissmer et al. 2023; Rigney 2010; Stanovich 1986



Call for evidence

Curriculum and
Assessment
Review

Supported by
Department
for Education



Department
for Education

Leading education expert, Professor Becky Francis CBE,
named as review chair.



Curriculum and Assessment Review: Review Aims, Terms of Reference and Working Principles

Review Aims

The Curriculum and Assessment Review Group will undertake a review of the existing national curriculum and statutory assessment system, including qualification pathways. The Review will seek to refresh the curriculum to ensure it is cutting edge, fit for purpose and meeting the needs of children and young people to support their future life and work. The Review will ensure that the curriculum appropriately balances ambition, excellence

1. It's an 8-week consultation

The call for evidence opens today and runs until November 22. That's eight weeks to have your say. You can fill in the [consultation here](#).

The review has "deliberately kept questions as open as possible, and welcome responses from all those interested: young people and their parents, teachers, lecturers, education leaders, subject experts, researchers, employers and others".

Curriculum review launches call for evidence

tes
magazine
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Professor Becky Francis warns that the current system is failing a third of pupils and says the review will focus on disadvantaged students

SCHOOLS
WEEK

Tuesday, 15 Oct 2024

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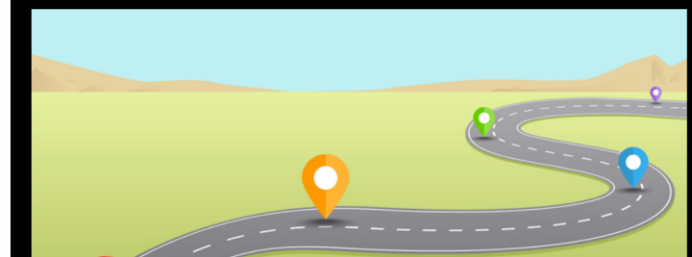
Curriculum

Dates revealed for curriculum review national roadshow

11 events scheduled this autumn for sector to give their views

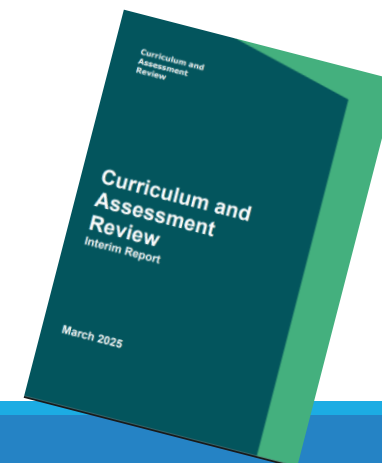
Schools Week Reporter
15 Oct 2024, 10:42
More from this author

See discussion



Key priority areas from the interim report:

- ❑ Ensure the education system supports **every learner**, especially those with *special needs* and from *disadvantaged backgrounds*.
- ❑ Balance the curriculum to teach important subjects deeply without overwhelming students.
- ❑ Prepare students for the future by including skills like digital literacy and climate awareness.
- ❑ Improve pathways for 16 to 19-year-olds with better vocational and technical options to support diverse career goals.





What we want

Curriculum for a Changing Climate

The national curriculum has **not been substantively or systematically reviewed** for at least eight years, and doesn't look like it will happen anytime soon.

[Ten guiding principles](#)
[Executive summary](#)
[Presentation](#)
[Full report](#)
[Subject-specific documents](#)


Guiding principles

Using a 'tracked changes' methodology and a set of [guiding principles](#), we are showing what a new curriculum for England could look like:

- Students should be able to **appreciate the interconnectedness** of living and non-living things, **critically engaging** with the co-sustainability



News

SEND inclusion to be key focus of government's curriculum review

22 July 1 min read [Fiona Simpson](#)

[Education](#)

Barriers faced by disadvantaged children and those with special educational needs and disabilities (SEND) in mainstream schools will be central to a government-commissioned review of the school curriculum.



Issue 18: Curriculum innovation and impact

Published: May 2023

Guest Edited by: [David Leat](#)

This issue explores the theme of curriculum innovation and impact, with sections on:

- Collaboration and whole-school impact
- Creativity, knowledge and learning
- Wellbeing and the wider curriculum
- Innovative approaches to curriculum planning



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- Rebalance assessment
- Digital assessment and learning
- English and maths at 11–16
- Curriculum evolution at 11–16

Striking the balance: A review of 11–16 curriculum and assessment in England

OCR review makes case for curriculum and exams reform

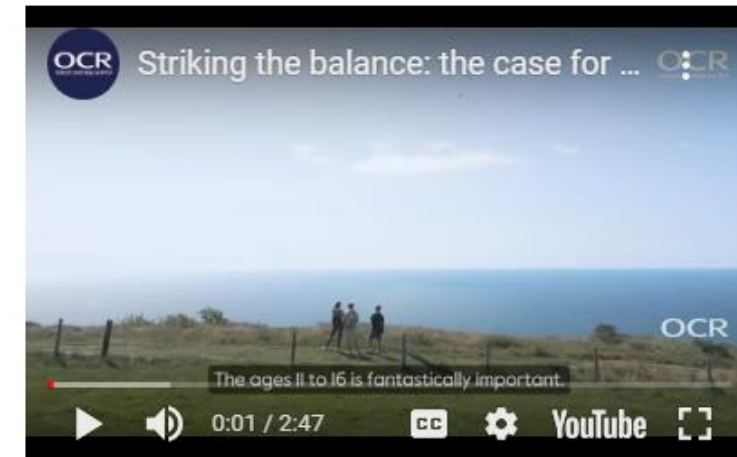
04 September 2024

Our major report, chaired by former Education Secretary Charles Clarke, warns that the current volume and intensity of exams at GCSE is too high, and an overloaded curriculum is narrowing students' education.

Striking the balance: A review of 11-16 curriculum and assessment in England recommends rebalancing assessment away from a sole reliance on exams at 16 – urging a more holistic approach across education from 11 to 16. Its recommendations are intended to provide an evolutionary and sustainable change to the sector.

[The report](#) also calls for an updated curriculum, and the creation of an independent body responsible for keeping it relevant, ending the cycle of infrequent 'big bang' reforms.

The report finds that many of the problems that become apparent when students take GCSEs are identifiable, and can be tackled, much earlier in students' secondary education. In English and maths, many students begin their GCSEs already behind on foundational skills that should have been attained at key stage 3 or earlier. This requires a holistic approach to education and assessment, so gaps in knowledge can be filled and students can demonstrate their progression well ahead of exams at age 16.

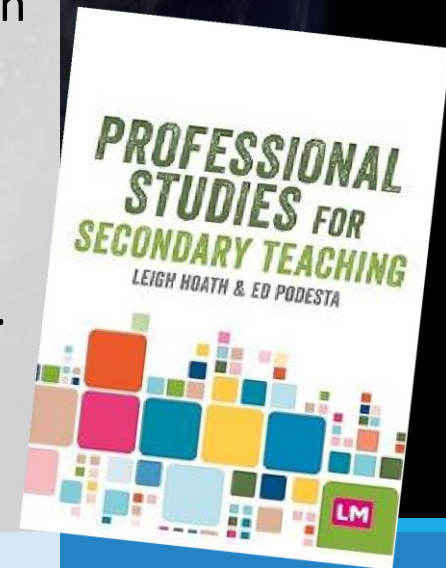




How will today's session
*influence your future
practice?*

Essential Readings

1. Biesta, G. (2009) Good education in an age of measurement: on the need to reconnect with the question of purpose in education. *Educational Assessment, Evaluation and Accountability*, 21(1).
2. Dave, H. and Wilson, S. (2023) 'The curriculum and the teacher' in Podesta, E and L Hoath. (ed.) *Professional Studies for Secondary Teaching*, London, Learning Matters, Sage Publishing.





Curriculum and the Teacher

1. The Purpose of Education and the Curriculum
2. Accountability + the Regulatory Frameworks
3. The Role of Knowledge